

RupeeRise – Designing an Adaptive Financial Behaviour System

HERO SECTION PLACEHOLDER

1. Context

Timeline: 14-day hackathon (research during weekday evenings, design and prototyping over weekends).

Role: Lead Product Designer (UX, UI, Product Thinking).

Platform: Mobile-first application.

Initial hackathon brief focused on improving financial literacy among teenagers and young earners.

The early assumption was that users lacked financial knowledge, and that better tracking and education would solve the problem.

2. Problem Reframing

During research and competitor analysis, it became clear that exposure to financial tools had significantly increased.

Young users were not lacking access to investing platforms or financial content.

The deeper issue was behavioural instability: impulsive investing, fear of irreversible loss, and overconfidence influenced by short-term gain narratives.

The refined focus shifted from knowledge deficit to designing guardrails that reduce impulsive behaviour while building investing confidence.

Financial literacy remained essential, but as a supporting layer within a behavioural system.

3. Constraints

Research was lightweight but focused due to time constraints.

Validation was limited to short-term feedback within the hackathon timeline.

Long-term behavioural measurement was outside the project scope.

4. Research Summary

Primary Inputs: Informal interviews and discussions with early earners about spending habits, credit usage, and investing fears.

Secondary Inputs: Review of Indian fintech apps, investing platforms, and influencer content trends.

Key Observations:

- Fear of losing real money prevents action.
- Dashboards often increase anxiety instead of clarity.
- Beginners either avoid investing completely or jump in impulsively.
- Consistency and behavioural guardrails matter more than feature depth.

5. Core Metric

The core metric of RupeeRise is behavioural progression toward stable financial decision-making.

This includes consistency in tracking, completion of learning modules, simulation engagement before capital exposure, and gradual increase in investment limits.

Success is measured by behavioural maturity, not transaction volume.

6. Product Structure – Four Pillars

1. Behaviour Awareness

Tracking functions as a behavioural signal engine rather than a passive expense log.

It detects discretionary spending spikes, supports budget awareness, and enables contextual nudges aligned with user goals.

2. Structured Learning

Learning modules simplify financial concepts and validate understanding through quizzes.

Progression is gated by competency to ensure readiness before exposure.

3. Simulation Before Capital

Users begin with stock market simulation using real market data.

Simulation provides emotional exposure to volatility without financial loss.

Mandatory in early stages, adaptive in mature stages.

4. Adaptive Guardrails

System modes: Guarded Mode (high friction), Guided Mode (moderate friction), Autonomous Mode (low friction with critical alerts active).

If risky deviation patterns emerge, friction is gradually reintroduced instead of instantly restoring strict controls.

Critical alerts remain non-removable to maintain safety integrity.

INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE PLACEHOLDER

LOW FIDELITY WIREFRAMES PLACEHOLDER

HIGH FIDELITY UI SCREENS PLACEHOLDER

7. Interaction Philosophy

Primary tone: Calming.

Secondary tone: Stabilising.

Tertiary layer: Controlled gamification (streaks, milestones, maturity levels).

No urgency-driven notifications or FOMO mechanics are introduced.

8. Monetization Philosophy

Monetization is layered after sustained behavioural maturity.

Potential channels include mentor sessions, advanced analytics, and goal-aligned financial partnerships.

High-risk asset promotion, luxury signalling, and impulse-driven advertising are intentionally excluded.

9. Validation & Jury Feedback

User feedback indicated that simulation reduced intimidation around investing.

Progress-based framing felt less stressful than balance-heavy dashboards.

Jury acknowledged responsible system design and behavioural focus, while noting the need for long-term validation to measure sustained impact.

10. Reflection

RupeeRise evolved from a literacy-focused concept into a behaviour-first financial system.

The project reinforced that designing for finance requires balancing autonomy with adaptive guardrails.

The aim is stable independence through progression, not permanent restriction.